



August 12, 2026

Dear Parents and Guardians,

Hello and welcome to English as a Second Language. My teaching experience at Mary, Star of the Sea School includes more than fifteen years of first grade, one year of third grade, and three years of English as a Second Language.

I will provide a safe, engaging, and nurturing Christ-centered environment where your child will be inspired to speak, listen, write, and read the English language.

When families and teachers work together, all students benefit from a consistent, supportive, and nurturing learning environment that respects cultural diversity and promotes academic success for all. I look forward to teaching your child this year.

Thank you for your support,

Mrs. Tanaka, ktanaka@starofthesea.org

Mary, Star of the Sea School



ACADEMICS:

- **Communication** is both written and oral. Students will understand and follow written and oral directions by reading and listening.
- **Explode the Code** is used for phonics and reinforcement.
- **Spelling Skills** cover spelling patterns, capitalization, and vocabulary development at the students' level.
- **Language Arts** covers parts of speech and sentence structure.
- **Reading Skills** focus on Facts, Sequence, Context, Main Idea, Conclusion, and Inference.

Imagine Learning :

Language & Literacy is an online reading program that focuses on skills like vocabulary, comprehension, fluency, phonics, and phonemic awareness.

- **Writing Skills** cover personal narratives, informative writing, descriptive writing, opinion and comparative writing, and poetry.

ASSESSMENTS:

* **WIDA** is a research-based organization that supports teachers of multilingual learners. It provides online assessments to help students develop academic language proficiency. It focuses on advancing academic language development and achievement for these students.

* **Imagine Learning** provides online assessments that help teachers understand a student's language and literacy needs. These assessments identify specific strengths and weaknesses, allowing for targeted instruction and intervention.

Let's work together to soar with Jesus !



THE CLASSROOM :

- Every student shall behave in a safe and appropriate manner as not to cause injury to self and classmates. The MSOS Student Conduct rules (see handbook online) must be followed at all times.
- MSOS 's Schoolwide Learning Expectations (SLEs Grade K-4) along with the school's mission and vision are integrated into the curriculum and structured to foster growth in our students to become ...
- **SELF AWARE, CONFIDENT INDIVIDUALS; TEACHABLE LIFELONG, INDEPENDENT LEARNERS; ACTIVE CHRISTIANS; and RESPONSIBLE CITIZENS.** (see handbook online for the full list)
- You should have received an ESL Supply List before school started. The required class supplies are: 1 wide ruled composition book, 1 labeled 2-pocket portfolio, 1 Expo dry erase marker and eraser, 1 yellow highlighter, 12 pencils, 2 erasers, and 1 pack of 3x5 lined white index cards.
- Technology - Your child will use their iPad in ESL class for online reading programs and assessments. Please be sure your child has their headphones in their homeroom class.
- Homework is always due the next day. Please return the workbook to school. Homework should be a review of the day's class work.
- Daily class work and homework are checked to show thoroughness, effort, and neatness.
- All tests are recorded in percentages.
- Report Cards are given at the end of each quarter.
- Parent Conferences are scheduled twice a year and as needed.



